

Mistral AI SAS (French: [mistʁal]) is a French artificial intelligence (AI) company headquartered in Paris. Founded in 2023, it develops large language models (LLMs), many of which are open-source AI, under licenses such as Apache. As of 2025, the company has a valuation of more than US\$14 billion, the highest among European AI companies.

As of August 2026, its largest public model is Mistral Large 3, released in December 2025, a mixture of experts model with 675 billion parameters, of which 41 are active. Mistral released Le Chat, its chatbot, in February 2024, renamed to Mistral Vibe in 2026.

Mistral is a primary beneficiary of a push by the European Union and its member governments towards digital sovereignty in response to the AI boom and AI arms race between the US and China. In September 2025, ASML, Europe's largest tech company and supplier of the semiconductor industry, invested €1.3 billion in Mistral, corresponding to an 11% shareholding.

Namesake

The company is named after the mistral, a powerful, cold wind in southern France, a term which originates from the Occitan language.

History

Mistral AI was established in April 2023 by three French AI researchers, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample and Timothée Lacroix.

Mensch, an expert in advanced AI systems, is a former employee of Google DeepMind; Lample and Lacroix, meanwhile, are large-scale AI models specialists who had worked for Meta Platforms.

The trio originally met during their studies at École Polytechnique.

In February 2026, Mistral acquired Koyeb, a Paris-based AI startup.

On 19 May 2026, Mistral AI announced its acquisition of the Austrian company Emmi AI, which

develops artificial intelligence simulation models for industrial engineering.

Company operation

Funding

In June 2023, the start-up carried out a first fundraising of €105 million (\$117 million) with investors including the American fund Lightspeed Venture Partners, Eric Schmidt, Xavier Niel and JCDcaux. The valuation was then estimated by the Financial Times at €240 million (\$267 million).

On 10 December 2023, Mistral AI announced that it had raised €385 million (\$428 million) as part of its second fundraising. This round of financing involves the Californian fund Andreessen Horowitz, BNP Paribas and the software publisher Salesforce. It was valued at over €2 billion.

On 26 February 2024, Microsoft announced an investment of \$16 million in Mistral AI.

On 16 April 2024, reporting revealed that Mistral was in talks to raise €500 million, a deal that would more than double its current valuation to at least €5 billion.

In June 2024, Mistral AI secured a €600 million (\$645 million) funding round, increasing its valuation to €5.8 billion (\$6.2 billion). Based on valuation, as of June 2024, the company was ranked fourth globally in the AI industry, and first outside the San Francisco Bay Area.

In April 2025, Mistral AI announced a €100 million partnership with the shipping company CMA CGM.

In August 2025, the Financial Times reported that Mistral was in talks to raise \$1 billion at a \$10 billion valuation. In September 2025, Bloomberg announced that Mistral AI has secured a €2 billion investment valuing it at €12 billion (\$14 billion). This comes after \$1.5 billion investment from Dutch company ASML, which owns 11% of Mistral.

In February 2026, Mistral AI announced a strategic partnership with Accenture to deploy enterprise AI at scale. Financial terms were not disclosed.

In March 2026, Mistral raised \$830 million in order to build new datacenters near Paris and in Sweden.

In July 2026, Mistral expanded its partnership with Microsoft through a multibillion-dollar agreement supporting the development of AI infrastructure in Europe. Microsoft agreed to use part of Mistral's expanded European computing capacity, while the companies added the Mistral Medium 3.5 and OCR 4 models to Microsoft Foundry and Medium 3.5 to Copilot Studio.

Services

On 19 November 2024, the company announced updates for Le Chat (French pronunciation: [lə ʃa]; lit. 'the cat'). It added the ability to create images, using Black Forest Labs' Flux Pro model.

On 6 February 2025, Mistral AI released Le Chat on iOS and Android mobile devices.

Mistral AI also introduced a Pro subscription tier, priced at \$14.99 per month, which provides access to more advanced models, unlimited messaging, and web browsing.

At the end of May 2026, Le Chat was renamed Vibe, and new features were introduced at the same time.

Political significance

As the largest and highest-valuation European artificial intelligence company, Mistral is a primary beneficiary of the push by the European Union and its member governments towards digital sovereignty in response to the AI boom and AI arms race between the US and China. In May 2026, CEO Arthur Mensch gave a speech to France's National Assembly arguing against France becoming a US "vassal state" including via the use of foreign AI in the French Armed Forces.

In September 2025, Dutch photolithography company ASML, Europe's largest tech company and a pillar of the semiconductor industry, invested €1.3 billion in Mistral, corresponding to an

11% shareholding.

Models

The following table lists the main model versions of Mistral, describing the significant changes included with each version:

Mistral 7B

Mistral AI claimed in the Mistral 7B release blog post that the model outperforms LLaMA 2 13B on all benchmarks tested, and is on par with LLaMA 34B on many benchmarks tested, despite having only 7 billion parameters, a small size compared to its competitors.

Mixtral 8x7B

Mistral AI claimed in 2023 that its model beat both LLaMA 70B, and GPT-3.5 in most benchmarks.

In March 2024, research conducted by Patronus AI comparing performance of LLMs on a 100-question test with prompts to generate text from books protected under U.S. copyright law found that OpenAI's GPT-4, Mixtral, Meta AI's LLaMA-2, and Anthropic's Claude 2 generated copyrighted text verbatim in 44%, 22%, 10%, and 8% of responses respectively.

Mistral Small 3.1

On 17 March 2025, Mistral released Mistral Small 3.1 as a smaller, more efficient model.

Mistral Medium 3

On 7 May 2025, Mistral AI released Mistral Medium 3.

Magistral Small and Magistral Medium

On 10 June 2025, Mistral AI released their first AI reasoning models: Magistral Small (open-source), and Magistral Medium, models which are purported to have chain-of-thought capabilities.

Mistral Large 3 and Ministral 3

On 2 December 2025, Mistral AI released Mistral Large 3, a sparse, mixture-of-experts model with 41 billion active parameters and 675 billion total parameters, and Ministral 3, three small, dense models with 3 billion, 7 billion and 14 billion parameters.

Devstral 2 and Devstral Small 2

On 10 December 2025, Mistral AI released Devstral 2 and Devstral Small 2. Devstral Small 2, a 24B parameter model is claimed to achieve better performance at coding than Qwen 3 Coder Flash model which is a 30B parameter model.

See also

Reasoning model

List of large language models

Lists of open-source artificial intelligence software

References

External links

Official website

Mistral AI on GitHub